

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 1 of 6

FREE

THE LITERAL GENIE LESSON

How to Talk to AI

Prompt writing for grades 6–8: AI is a literal genie — it grants what you **said**, not what you **meant**. Students learn to write genie-proof prompts.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

Cursed Wish Repair Shop



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

The genie's one rule: it grants exactly what you SAY — never what you MEANT. Genie-proof your wish with the three **P.R.O.** clauses:

- **P — Purpose:** what you want + who it's for
- **R — Requirements:** the fine print — length, tone, format, include / avoid
- **O — Output:** what the granted wish should look like



CURSED WISH #1 — AMARA'S SPACE POSTER

Amara's science poster is due Friday. She typed "tell me about space" — and got 40 pages on the history of NASA. Rewrite her wish so the genie can't miss:



CURSED WISH #2 — MATEO'S HEADPHONE FUND

Mateo gets \$15 a week and wants \$120 headphones. He typed "help me save money" — the genie answered, "Stop buying things." Rewrite his wish:



CURSED WISH #3 — YUKI'S HERO STORY

Yuki wants an anime-style story for the class zine. She typed "make a story about a hero" — the genie wrote: "Once there was a hero. The end." Rewrite her wish:

THE LITERAL GENIE LESSON • LESSON 1 OF 6

How to Talk to AI



A 45-minute prompt-writing lesson. The hook: AI is a literal genie — it grants exactly what your words ask for, not what your brain meant. Students learn the two human jobs in every AI task: start it well (the prompt) and end it well (the check).

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Cursed Wish Repair Shop worksheet (1 per student)	Optional — works fully unplugged	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Students can explain why the same AI gives different quality answers to different prompts.
- Students can apply the **P.R.O. framework** (Purpose, Requirements, Output) to write a clear prompt.
- Students can evaluate an AI response for accuracy and identify when to double-check.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.3.b

CCSS ELA W.6.4

Full standards text in the Teacher Guide.

♦ WARM-UP — THE WORST GENIE EVER (5 MIN)

Announce that you are a genie, and you will grant wishes *exactly as worded*. Take 3–4 wishes from the class and ruin every one, cheerfully:

"I wish I was rich." → "Granted. Your name is now Rich."

"I wish for million dollars." → "Granted — one million dollars, in play money."

"I wish school was over." → "Granted. The school building is now over... there."

Then ask: **whose fault was that — the genie's, or the wish?**

Bridge: "AI works like that genie. It doesn't know what you meant — it only knows what you SAID. Every AI job goes human, AI, human: you start it with the wish, the genie does the middle, and you check what comes back. Today you get good at both human parts."

✦ BE THE WORST GENIE EVER — BREAK YOUR PARTNER'S WISHES

Swap sheets. Read each repaired wish like a literal genie looking for a loophole, then score it:

GENIE-PROOF CHECKLIST	WISH 1	WISH 2	WISH 3
P — Clear purpose and audience?	☐	☐	☐
R — At least 2 pieces of fine print (length, tone, format, include/avoid)?	☐	☐	☐
O — Says what the output should look like?	☐	☐	☐
✦ Genie test — Genie-proof? (✓ only if the genie can't twist it)	☐	☐	☐

The sneakiest way you could twist one of their wishes (be specific — which wish, and how?):

✦ EXIT TICKET

1. Write one genie-proof prompt you could really use this week for homework class:

2. Genies are tricksters. AI can grant your wish with facts it made up — and sound totally confident. Name **ONE** thing in an AI answer you'd double-check, and where you'd check it. (No AI in class today? Imagine the answer you'd expect back.)

Keep it 100: If the genie does your homework, your name is on a wish you never earned — and teachers can tell. Use AI to think **WITH** you, not **FOR** you.